



IT'S A TYPICAL June afternoon in Haridwar. The sun is blazing down from a hot and copper sky, and the 43° C temperature has kept most people indoors. The occasional breeze lifts dust. After a tour of the Patanjali Research Institute near Bahadradab in Haridwar, Uttarakhand, we are headed along the Delhi-Haridwar highway to the Patanjali Foods & Herbal Park in Mus-tafabad village, some 25 km away. But Swami Ramdev's convoy disappears in a cloud of dust as his Range Rover shoots off along the narrower local road.

30 | Who would have thought that Swami Ramdev was a speed demon? Maybe sitting in a Range Rover (with a top speed of 290 kmph) with Z-category security does that to you. Or maybe it's the yoga guru's way of signalling his intent to double his Patanjali group's turnover to ₹1 lakh crore in just four years.

Patanjali Ayurved, co-founded by Swami Ramdev and Acharya Balkrishna in 2006 to make chyawanprash and ayurvedic products, had hit a turnover of nearly ₹2,000 crore by 2015. Group turnover soared to ₹5,000 crore on Patanjali's entry into the FMCG business using the Ayurveda and health plank and a franchisee model. Some corporate reengineering created a three-compa-

ny group—Patanjali Ayurved, Patanjali Foods and Patanjali Gramodhyog. In FY24, the group reported a turnover of ₹45,000 crore. The yoga guru recounts how people had sneered at him. "When we set revenue targets like ₹10,000 crore or ₹20,000 crore, people could not digest it. Now...[those] people are incredulous," says Ramdev, also the Non-executive Director of Patanjali Foods.

Chatting with us at the Patanjali Foods & Herbal Park, he talks of his next big dream: group turnover of ₹1 lakh crore by 2028. That's, like, more than doubling the group revenue in four years. Patanjali Foods was India's third-largest FMCG company last year. Hindustan Unilever (HUL) was India's largest FMCG firm in FY24, with revenues of ₹62,707 crore. It was followed by Adani Wilmar.

Is that a highly ambitious target, even by Ramdev's standards? Patanjali Ayurved grew 50-90% yearly from a few hundred crore in FY13 to ₹9,187 crore in FY17.

What's Ramdev's formula for growth this time? "In the coming days, we will increase our market share, grow our exports, and make some acquisitions in consumer goods," he says. But will it be as easy as it sounds, especially since the two Co-founders are facing the heat of the regulators and the Supreme Court on matters relating to their core belief in Ayurveda?

MISCOMMUNICATION OR MISLEADING?

The Supreme Court's strictures have hurt Patanjali's image. In August 2022, the Indian Medical Association (IMA) filed a writ petition in the apex court, alleging that Patanjali Ayurved has been 'misleading' the public with its 'false claims' about having cures for diabetes and high blood pressure. The matter went up to a two-judge bench, which found the advertisements to be 'prima facie' misleading, and Patanjali Ayurved had to promise it

THE PATANJALI PRESCRIPTION

► **Amid stagnant top-line growth for Patanjali Foods Ltd (PFL) and legal troubles, Swami Ramdev aims to double group revenue to ₹1 lakh crore by 2028**

► **By involving professional management, the Patanjali group is improving operational efficiency and charting a clear corporate strategy**

► **After successfully taking over Ruchi Soya (now called PFL), Ramdev is eyeing a bunch of acquisitions in the consumer goods space to boost top line**

► **Continued focus on strengthening manufacturing, expanding distribution and exports will be crucial for PFL to achieve ₹50,000 crore top line in four years**

► **With an aim to boost sales, profits and secure investors' interests, PFL is acquiring Patanjali Ayurved's key home and personal care portfolio**

► **To lure young, urban and well-off consumers, PFL is establishing a premium product line; Ramdev is also betting on sectors like healthcare and education**